



About

Axel Annica Karlsson Rixon
Visual Artist / Photographer / Researcher
PhD in Photography

Member of the board Gothenburg Visual Arts Workshop, Member of Swedish Association of Professional Photographers (SFF) and Center for Photography (CFF)

Born 1962 in Västra Frölunda, Sweden, Resides at Brännö (Gothenburg), Sweden. Pronoun: they/them
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Education and Research visits (short list)

- 2016 *Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)*, Valand Academy, University of Gothenburg, Sweden.
Subject: Photography (Fotografisk gestaltning). Title: *Queer Community through Photographic Acts. Three Entrances to an Artistic Research Project Approaching the Russian LGBTQIA Community.*
- 2014 *Visiting Scholar/Artist*, BBRG Affiliated Scholars Program, Department of Gender and Women's Studies, University of California Berkeley, Ca, USA.
- 2009/10 *Visiting Scholar*, Rhetoric Department, University of California Berkeley, Ca, USA. Bo Samuelson's Doctoral Exchange Program.
- 1997 *Master of Fine Art (MFA)*, California Institute of the Arts, Valencia, Ca, USA
- 1988 *Nordic School of Photography* (Nordens Fotoskola), Stockholm, Sweden.

Exhibitions (selection last ten years)

- 2026 Body. Ideal, Gaze, Freedom. Gothenburg Museum of Art.
- 2025 *Tied*, Gothenburg Fine Arts Society (solo exhibition).
Traces of Vulnerable Existence, 3e Gallery Floor, Gothenburg (solo exhibition).
Abuse of Power Comes as No Surprise. Art from Marika and CG Wachtmeisters Collection, Vandalorum Museum of Art and Design, Värnamo.
- 2024 *In the power of our unexpressed or unrecognized feelings*, Open Art 2024, Örebro Konsthall.

At the Time of the Third Reading / Во время третьего чтения, Art Space Södertörn University, Stockholm (solo exhibition).

Hjärtahjärna (Heartbrain) – 50 years of contemporary art through Marika and CG Wachtmeister's collection, Liljevalchs+, Stockholm.

- 2023 *Perceptions of time. Works from the collection*. Borås Museum of Art.
202 people in one room: Portraits from the Hasselblad Foundation collection. Hasselblad center, Gothenburg.
- 2022 *Faraway Close*, House of Sweden, Washington DC.
When postmodernism came to town. Academy of Fine Arts, Stockholm.
The Corona Collection – The Swedish Arts Council's new acquisitions 2021. Havremagasinet, Boden and Skissernas Museum, Lund.
Darkroom / Underground Club: Gothenburg's photo scene 1985 - 95, Hasselblad Center, Göteborg.
Vårsalongen 100 år. Liljevalchs Konsthall, Stockholm..
Why Hesitate? Marika and CG Wachtmeister's Art Collection. Kristianstads konsthall, Kristianstad.
- 2021 *Towards another world. 25 years of Swedish contemporary art – Stena A Olsson's Cultural Scholarship*, Gothenburg Art Museum.
(in)visible, Malmö Art Museum, Malmö, Sweden. Works from the collection from a queer perspective.
(in)visible, Malmö city archive.
Dear Truth: Documentary Strategies in Contemporary Photography, Hasselblad Center, Gothenburg.
- 2020 *Generation. A reflection of the 1990s art scene*, Borås Art Museum.
Nakenakt (Nude), Thomassen Gallery, Gothenburg (solo exhibition).
- 2019 *1989 – Culture and Politics*, National Museum, Stockholm.
Published. Photo Books in Sweden, Center for Photography, Stockholm.
- 2018 *Nakenak (Nude)t*, 18th street Art Center 30 Years Celebration, Santa Monica, Ca, USA. 10.11.18
Pendulum - Moving Goods, Moving People -- in photographs from the MAST collection, Fondazione MAST, Bologna, Italy.
Memorable Mobility, solo exhibition at Musée des Beaux-Arts, Rouen, France (solo exhibition).
Nakenakter (Nudes). Agunbiade-Kolawole, Karlsson Rixon and Zorn. The Thiel Gallery, Stockholm.
Published. Photo Books in Sweden, Hasselblad Center, Gothenburg.
Traces of Vulnerable Existence, Gallery Format, Malmö (solo exhibition).
- 2017 *Signs*, Sundsvall Museum, Sundsvall.

2016 *Crucifixion of the female martyrdom (re-visit)*, Verk / Curerar, Skeppsholmen (outdoor screening, live music with Tsomak Oga)

State of Mind - Queer lives in Russia, Museum of World Culture, Gothenburg (solo exhibition).

In Your Clothes, Borås Art Museum, Borås.

The Artist. Entrepreneur. Genius. Avant-gardist. Norm-breaker. Visionary. Traveler., the National Museum @ Academy of Art, Stockholm.

Deed. Photography from the Collection, Gothenburg Museum of Art, Gothenburg.

Represented in following art collections

The Portrait Collections at the Royal Library, Copenhagen (1989)

The Art Museum of Bosnia and Hercegovina, Sarajevo, Former Yugoslavia (1994)

Moderna Museum, Stockholm, Sweden (1993, 2000, 2012)

The Bonnier Art Collection, Stockholm, Sweden (1993)

Borås Art Museum, Borås, Sweden (1994)

Erna and Victor Hasselblad Foundation, Gothenburg, Sweden (1998, 2013)

Public Art Agency Sweden (1998, 2021)

Wanås Foundation, Wanås, Sweden (1998)

Norrköping Art Museum, Norrköping, Sweden (1998, 2018)

Göteborg Art Musuem, Gothenburg, Sweden (1998, 2008, 2016, 2022)

Swedish General Association of Fine Arts (SAK), Sweden (1999)

Skövde Art Museum, Skövde, Sweden (2002)

Malmö Art Musuem, Malmö, Sweden (2005, 2013, 2014, 2018)

Stena Foundation, Gothenburg, Sweden (2007)

The Museum of Photography, Sundsvall, Sweden (2012)

Gävleborg art collection, Gävle, Sweden (2013)

Region Västra Götaland public art collection, Sweden (2017)

Fondazione MAST, Bologna, Italy (2018)

Gothenburg City Art Collection, Sweden (2020)

Firestorm Foundation, Stockholm, Sweden (2024)

The Tangen Collection, Kunstsilo, Kristiansand, Norway (2025)

Grants, Support and Awards (last ten years)

2025 Adlerbertska Culture Grant, awarded to leading cultural figures in Gothenburg, appointed by the Gnistan Society.

2024 Göteborg city, Board of Culture, Gothenburg City, Project support PRONTO (Tied, exhibition production)

2024 IASPIS/ Swedish Arts Grants Committee, travel grant (Traces of Vulnerable Existence, Los Angeles)

- 2021 Karl Staaf foundation (Preserving stories. Making herstory)
- 2020 Kavalla Stipend, Greece. Swedish Professional Photographers Association. (2 weeks residency)
- 2019 Svensk Bokkonst 2018, Royal Library, Stockholm, Sweden. Juryns motivation: "Diskret och fint omslag med skimrande prägling på grå kartong omsluter ett leporelloband som vecklar ut sig till två starka berättelser, med bild på ena sidan och text på den andra."
<https://svenskbokkonst.blogg.kb.se/vinnare-2018/>
- 2018 Swedish Arts Council, support for image-based literature for adults (*Nakenakt*)
- 2018 Helge Ax:son Johnsons Foundation grant (*Horizon of Expectation* with Mikela Lundahl Hero)
- 2018 Hasselblad Foundation photo book grant (book production *Nakenakt*)
- 2018 Längmanska Culture Foundation (book production *Nakenakt*)
- 2018 Swedish Arts Grants Committee, project grant (*Horizon of Expectation* with Mikela Lundahl Hero).
- 2017 IASPIS/ Swedish Arts Grants Committee, international cultural exchange grant (18th Street Art Center Los Angeles 2018)
- 2016 Längmanska Culture Foundation (book production *At the Time of the Third Reading/Во время третьего чтения*)

Artist and Research Residencies

Kavalla Residency Stipend, Greece. Swedish Professional Photographers Association. (2 weeks 2021)

18th Street Art Center's international visiting artist residency program, Los Angeles, USA. Supported by IASPIS - International Artist' Studio Program in Sweden (studio residency, 2 months, 2018).

Hôtel Cheillon, Grez-sur-Loing Foundation, Grez-sur-Loing, France. Supported by Anna Ahrenberg's foundation for scientific and other purposes (2 months, 2016).

BBRG Affiliated Scholars Program, Department of Gender and Women's Studies, University of California Berkeley, CA, USA (2 months visiting scholar, 2014).

Husly Artist Residency, Trondheim, Norway (studio residency, 6 weeks, 2014).

Bo Samuelsson PhD Exchange Program at UC Berkeley (two semester visiting scholar at Rhetoric Department, 2009/10).

Pro Arte Foundation for Culture and Arts, St. Petersburg, Russia. Supported by Nifca - Nordic Institute for Contemporary Art (2 months, 2006).

International Artist Studio Program in Stockholm, Sweden. Supported by IASPIS - International Artist' Studio Program in Sweden (studio residency 6 months, 2001).

Mázejoavku housing and studios, Maze, Norway. Supported by Nifca - Nordic Institute for Contemporary Art (studio residency, 2 months, 2000).

Headlands Center for the Arts, San Francisco, USA. Supported by Nunsku (studio residency, 5 months, 1994).

Publications (selection last ten years)

- 2021 *I riktning mot ett annat Sverige: I dialog med Ingrid Segerstedt Wiberg (Towards another Sweden: in dialogue with Ingrid Segerstedt Wiberg)*. Photography, text and concept A. Karlsson Rixon. Co-authors: Parvin Ardalan, Anette Carlsson, Macarena Dusant and a group of asylum seekers. Part of a public art project, ISBN: 978-91-985956-0-4.
- 2019 *Några dagar i Grekland (Some days in Greece)*, photography Axel Karlsson Rixon, text Mikela Lundahl Hero. Ord & Bild no 2/19, tema Europa, p. 8 - 19, and cover (text and photo essay).
- 2018 *Nakenakt (Nude)*. Karlsson Rixon and Mara Lee. Photography, editor and design. Art and Theory Publishing, Stockholm (artist book), ISBN 978-91-88031-65-5. One of the winners of design award Sweden Book Art 2018
- 2018 *Mobilité Memorable / Memorable Mobility*. Lumière Nordique, Musée des Beaux-Arts de Rouen. Essays by Mikela Lundahl Hero and Gabriel Burat. Introductions by Joanne Snrech and Karlsson Rixon, ISBN 978-2-900314-07-4 (exhibition catalogue)
- 2016 *At the Time of the Third Reading/Во время третьего чтения*. Editor, photography and introduction Annica Karlsson Rixon, texts and interviews with/by Dmitri Bartenev, Elena Botsman, Jack Halberstam, Hana Kochetkova, Nadia Plungian and Sasha Semeyonova. Art and Theory Publishing, Stockholm (book), ISBN 978-91-88031-29-7
- 2016 *Queer Community through Photographic Acts. Three Entrances to an Artistic Research Project Approaching LGBTQI Russia*. Art and Theory Publishing, Stockholm (dissertation thesis, book) <https://gupea.ub.gu.se/handle/2077/44950>, ISBN 978-91-88031-03-7
- 2014 *Här är vi (Here We Are)*, Stockholm Konst, photographs, introduction and text, editors Lena From and Annica Karlsson Rixon. (book), ISBN 978-91-978560-7-2
- Annica Karlsson Rixon interviews Ulrika Stahre, The Brooklyn Rail. Critical Perspectives on Arts, Politics, and Culture. Special issue: On the State of Art Criticism in Europe. AICA USA. May 2014.*
- 2013 *In Spite of All*, Gender Research Journal, TEMA Artistic Research, nr 1, 2013, peer reviewed article by Annica Karlsson Rixon and Lena Martinsson. Selected "article of the month" by Qaisar Mahmood, Tidskriftsrevyn #6, 2013
- 2012 *Handlingsrymd*, Paletten Nr 4:2011 – 1:2012, essay by Annica Karlsson Rixon & Anna Viola Hallberg. *Moment: Grimmered. Documents – Memories – Stories*, in Worlds and Realities, Länsmuseum Gävleborg and Gävle Konstcentrum. Text and works by Annica Karlsson Rixon and Anna Viola Hallberg. Editors Anna Livion-Invarsson, Ann Nilsén, Niclas Östlind. (exhibition catalogue)
- 2011 *Translations in movement - Experimental ethnography and artistic research*, Cultural Persepctives, Swedish ethnology journal, Nr 3-4, 2011, article by Annica Karlsson Rixon and Lena Martinsson
- 2009 *The Museum as Context*, Museale Forstyrelser – ett förøksprojekt av Norsk Kulturråd, essay by Annica Karlsson Rixon & Anna Viola Hallberg, commissioned essay by Arts Council Norway, covering a pilot project with contemporary art in heritage museum (book)

- 2008 Talkin' Loud and Sayin' Something – four aspects of artistic research, State of Mind, text and works by Annica Karlsson Rixon and Anna Viola Hallberg, interview by Mika Hannula, Art Monitor – a journal on artistic research, no 4, 2008.

Catalogues, Essays, Articles, Research Publications and Interviews

(by other authors, selection last ten years)

- 2024 Teubner, Maike, Northern Light – Scandinavian Pain. (De)constructions of the 'Nordic' in exhibitions and contemporary art, Reimer Verlag, fall 2024. (Doctoral dissertation, Art History, Faculty of Philosophy at the Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg, FAU)
- Polkov, Kirill. Queering Images of Russia in Sweden. Discursive Hegemony and Counter-Hegemonic Articulations 1991-2019. Södertörn Doctoral Dissertations. Södertörn University, Stockholm 2024. Chapter 3: Embracing backwardness: Recognition in Swedish visual arts. ISBN 978-91-89504-75-2 (print) / 978-91-89504-76-9 (digital)
- In the power of our unexpressed and unrecognized feelings*. Örebro konsthall. Open Art Örebro, (catalogue).
- 2022 Näslund Dahlgren, Anna (ed.). Fotografihistorier (Photography Histories). Natur och Kultur, 2022. ISBN 978-91-27177-00-0.
- 2021 Art and Migration. Revisioning the borders of community. Manchester University Press, 2021. Ed. Bénédicte Miyamoto and Marie Ruiz, Chapter: Memorable Mobilities, an interview with Axel A Karlsson Rixon, ISBN 978-1-5261-4970-1 (interview by editors)
- 2020 Masterworks of industrial photography. Exhibitions 2018. Mast Foundation. MAST. Electra. ed. Laura Guidetti and Laura Maggioni,
- 2019 Vikram, Anuradha and Yank, Sue Bell (eds). 18th Street Arts Center 2018-2019, ISBN: 978-0-9908119-6-1 (catalogue)
- Hedström, Per (ed.), 1989 – Kultur och politik. National Museum Stockholm (catalogue) ISBN 9789171008930
- 2016 Meskimmon, Marsha, *As a woman, my country is...: on imag(in)ed communities and the heresy of becoming-denizen*, Home/Land. Women, Citizenship, Photographies. Ed. Marion Arnorld ad Marsha Meskimmon. Liverpool University Press, 2016. ISBN 978-1-78138-280-6 (essay)

Education and Research visits

- 2018 *The Photographic Artist's Book: Dissemination in a Digital Landscape*, Royal Institute of the Arts, Stockholm, Sweden. One-year post-grad studies in book design and publishing.
- 2017 *Show Time: Bodies, Spectacle and Unpopular Culture, workshop for researchers with professor Jack Halberstam*, Institution for culture and aesthetics, Stockholm University. 11.05.17

- 2016 *Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)*, Valand Academy, University of Gothenburg, Sweden.
Subject: Photography (Fotografisk gestaltning). Title: *Queer Community through Photographic Acts. Three Entrances to an Artistic Research Project Approaching the Russian LGBTQIA Community.*
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- 2009/10 *Visiting Scholar*, Rhetoric Department, University of California Berkeley, Ca, USA. Bo Samuelson's Doctoral Exchange Program.
- 1997 *Master of Fine Art (MFA)*, California Institute of the Arts, Valencia, Ca, USA
- 1988 *Nordic School of Photography* (Nordens Fotoskola), Stockholm, Sweden.

Teaching

- 2003-07 Professor, education responsible for the Master Program, School of Photography/Valand Academy, University of Gothenburg, Sweden
- 2000-01 Lecturer, Department of Fine Art, Konstfack - University College of Arts, Crafts and Design, Stockholm, Sweden
- 1999-2000 Lecturer, School of Photography and Film, University of Gothenburg, Sweden
- 1994-95 Guest teacher, School of Art and Communication, Turku, Finland
- 1991-92 Teacher, Preparatory School of Photography (GFU), Folkuniversitetet, Stockholm, Sweden

Boards and Committees

- 2025 - Member of the board Gothenburg Visual Arts Workshop.
- 2023 Jury Documentary Photography Residence, Sune Jonsson Centrum för Dokumentärfotografi (SJCD), Umeå.
- 2019-23 The Visual Arts Fund, Sweden Arts Grant Committee, member of the board.
- 2019-21 IASPIS delegation (International Artist Studio Program in Sweden), Sweden Arts Grant Committee, member of the board.
- 2014/16 F-Re:search – network for academic and artistic feminist research, member of the working group.
- 2013 Svilova residency stipend Berlin, Gothenburg, Sweden, jury member.
- 2011/13 Centre for Interdisciplinary Gender Research, University of Gothenburg, Sweden. Member of steering committee.
- 2009 2009 Hasselblad Award. Member of the prize committee for the together with David Chandler, Catherine David, Sunhee Kim and Jorge Ribalta.
Member of the expert committee together with curator Lynne Cooke, professor Jan Kaila and professor Olav Christopher Jenssen reviewing for the appointment of three professorships in art, Malmö Art Academy, Malmö, Sweden.
Swedish Arts Council, member of the working team for support of literature in the area of illustrated work. Qualitative evaluation in order to provide funding for publishers in Sweden to publish certain newly produced works of value both in artistic terms and also in respect of cultural policy.

- Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden
- 2008 Swedish Arts Council, member of the working team for support of literature in the area of illustrated work. Qualitative evaluation in order to provide funding for publishers in Sweden to publish certain newly-produced works of value both in artistic terms and also in respect of cultural policy.
- Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden
- 2007 Hasselblad Center Artistic Advisory Board, together with Øivind Storm Bjerke and Lars Schwander, Gothenburg, Sweden
- Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden (deputy)
- 2006/07 Member of the expert committee together with professor Jan Kaila and professor Jan Brockman reviewing for the appointment of the Professor in Art specialized in Photography, Video and Film, Oslo National Academy of the Arts, Oslo, Norway
- 2006 Hasselblad Center Artistic Advisory Board, together with Øivind Storm Bjerke and Lars Schwander, Gothenburg, Sweden
- Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden (deputy)
- 2005 Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden (deputy)
- Member of the local committee, IASPIS (International Artist Residency Program), Gothenburg, Sweden
- Exhibition Committee, Center of Photography (CFF), Stockholm, Sweden
- 2004 Member of the Board, INDEX foundation for contemporary art, Stockholm (chair)
- Member of the Board, Baltic Art Center, Visby, Sweden (deputy)
- Member of the local committee, IASPIS (International Artist Residency Program), Gothenburg, Sweden
- Exhibition Committee, Center of Photography (CFF), Stockholm, Sweden
- 2003 Member of the Board, INDEX foundation for contemporary art, Stockholm (chairperson)
- Member of the local committee, IASPIS (International Artist Residency Program), Gothenburg, Sweden
- 2002 Member of the Board, INDEX foundation for contemporary art, Stockholm (chairperson)
- 2001 Member of the Board, INDEX foundation for contemporary art, Stockholm (chairperson)
- 2000 Expert committee, reviewing for the appointment of a lecturer in photography, School of Photography, University of Gothenburg, Sweden.
- 1991/93 Member of the Committee, Friends of the Photographic Museum (FMV), Stockholm, Sweden
- 1991 Member of the Committee, Women Photographers in Scandinavia (KFN), Stockholm, Sweden (chairperson)
- 1991 Member of the Committee, Women Photographers in Scandinavia (KFN), Stockholm, Sweden (chairperson)
- 1989 Member of the Committee, Women Photographers in Scandinavia (KFN), Stockholm, Sweden
- 1989 Founder and board member of Female Photographers in Scandinavia (KFN)